Whose am I?

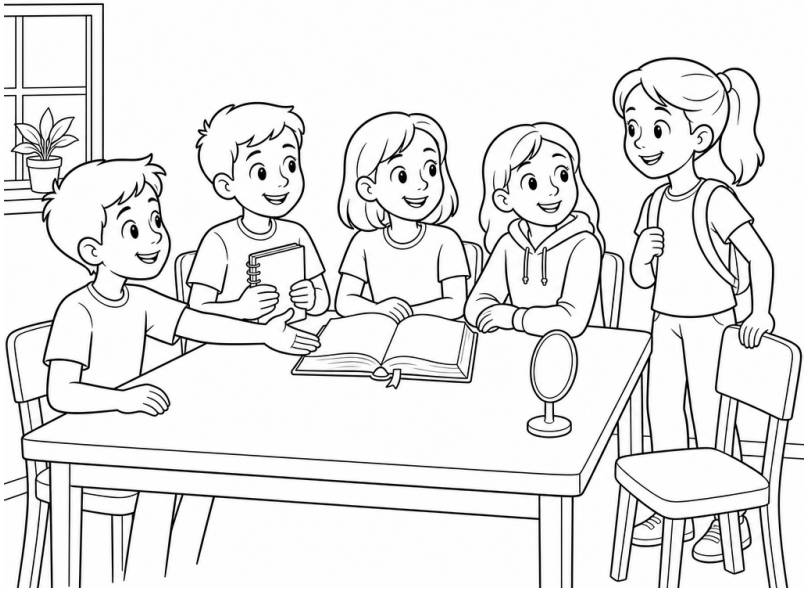
Michael pulled up a chair for Ben. Beside the Bible, Anna's two mirrors were still on the table.

"I was only asking, 'Who am I?'" Michael said. "Now I'm wondering, 'Whose am I?' Can I earn a place with Jesus by being kind?"

"No," Anna answered. "Mercy is His gift. Good behavior and going to church cannot buy it. You can turn to Jesus and trust Him to forgive you."

Michael looked around the table. Being picked last still hurt, but it did not have the last word. He wanted to keep listening to Jesus.

Color the welcome at the table. Who could you make room for this week? Tell someone what you would say.



What would you like to ask Jesus? You can talk honestly with Him and ask a trusted adult to help you understand.

Who am I?

The last one picked

Read the passage

Michael dragged his feet after the game. Everyone else had been picked before him.

"Maybe nobody wants me," he told Rosie.

Rosie sat beside him and listened. Then they went inside to find Anna, their group leader. Anna drew two mirrors on a sheet of paper.

"This one asks what people think of us," she said. "But can being popular tell you who you really are?"

Michael shook his head. Anna opened her Bible beside the other mirror.

"Let's listen to what God says. Peter wrote these words to people who belong to Jesus."

Michael followed as she read. "What does chosen mean?" he asked. "Can someone picked last belong to Him too?"

"Yes," Anna said. "God doesn't choose His people because they win games or impress everyone. Through Christ, He brings them into His family."

But you are a chosen race, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, a people for his own possession, that you may proclaim the excellencies of him who called you out of darkness into his marvelous light.

1 Peter 2:9 • ESV

Can I talk to God?

Michael pointed to another word. “Does priesthood mean we all become pastors?”

“No,” Anna said. “Jesus is our King. His people can come to God through Him, pray, and serve others.”

“Could I pray about feeling left out?” Michael asked.

“Yes, right now,” Rosie said. “You don’t have to wait for a pastor.”

“But I still get things wrong,” Michael said. “How could I be holy?”

“Holy means set apart to belong to God, not already perfect,” Anna explained. “He teaches His people to live His way.”

Michael bowed his head. “God, please help me notice someone who feels alone.”

Find the eight words across, down, or diagonally. Some run backward. As you search, remember what Anna explained to Michael.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
1	S	V	Z	Y	F	U	M	B	T	P	N	T
2	G	U	T	S	X	C	K	W	E	Y	Y	H
3	P	X	S	N	U	N	H	O	C	Y	S	G
4	R	C	D	E	D	Q	P	O	L	Z	C	I
5	O	I	V	R	J	L	Z	O	S	L	U	L
6	C	O	L	G	E	V	H	V	V	E	K	V
7	L	S	Z	V	P	T	D	C	P	I	N	F
8	A	P	R	I	E	S	T	H	O	O	D	I
9	I	L	K	N	E	U	Z	R	B	W	N	T
10	M	Y	E	E	D	A	S	K	R	V	T	X
11	D	X	A	A	O	N	S	A	Y	C	S	Q
12	S	Y	C	R	E	M	Z	S	Y	F	Z	R

CHOSEN • PRIESTHOOD • HOLY • PEOPLE • MERCY • LIGHT • JESUS • PROCLAIM

Room for one more

When they went outside, someone laughed when Ben dropped the ball. Michael remembered standing alone. What if they laughed at him too? Then he remembered that God teaches His people to live differently.

“Come with us, Ben,” he said. Rosie helped Ben pick up the ball, and they walked inside together.

“Is this your church?” Ben asked.

“The church is the people who belong to Jesus,” Anna said. “We care for each other, even when we meet somewhere else.”

At the table, they made room for Ben, who was visiting for the first time.

“Why were you kind when the others laughed?” he asked.

“Jesus has shown us mercy,” Rosie said. “He died for our sins and rose again. He forgives us and teaches us to love people too.”

As Ben listened, Michael understood: God’s people show His goodness and tell others about Him.

Once you were not a people, but now you are God’s people; once you had not received mercy, but now you have received mercy.

1 Peter 2:10 • ESV

Help Michael remember the afternoon. Write the letter of the best reply beside each question. Use each letter once.

1. Why could Michael pray right away? ____

2. Who was the church, even outside the building? ____

3. Why did Rosie tell Ben about Jesus? ____

A. His people share the mercy He has shown them.

B. Through Jesus, His people can come to God.

C. The people who belong to Jesus were the church.